	Onkyo	Croma	Creative	JBL	Philips	Bang & Olufsen
	ABX-100	iPod T Speaker	Ziisound D5	OnBeat Xtreme	DS9000/ 12	BeoSound 8
	6.22	5.58	10.47	22.20	32.82	45.87
	5.40	8.80	9.00	11.40	7.40	12.00
	11.62	14.38	19.47	33.6	40.22	57.87
	₹15,000	₹9,000	₹19,999	₹24,990	₹38,999	₹85,000
	10	60	NA	120	100	NA
	40 – 20	20 - 20	NA	47 - 22	NA	NA
	2	2	2	4	4	72
	3	4	3	4	24	72
	10	10	10	24	72	72
	4	1	10	42	90	90
	3	4	10	24	72	72
	4	3	3	42	42	72
	4	4	24	24	42	90
	26	4	24	72	72	95
	24	4	24	45	45	76.5
	10	10	10	45	45	76.5
	10	2	24	42	72	72
	4	3	42	45	72	72
	3	3	4	24	24	72
	3.5	3	4	10	26	76.5
	4	3	4	24	42	72
	4	3.5	10	24	10	72
	4.5	24	11	42	76.5	90
	35	**35**	**55**	**85**	**95**	**85**
	4	0	0	4	42	0
	10	4	24	42	42	72
	35	20	45	85	80	95
	0	0	10	10	0	0
	10	10	10	10	10	10
	0	10	0	0	0	10
	0	10	0	0	0	0
	0	0	0	0	0	10
	0	10	0	0	0	0
	0	10	0	0	0	0
	0	0	0	10	0	0
	10	10	10	10	10	10
	10	0	0	10	10	0
	0	0	0	10	0	0
	0	0	0	0	0	0
	0	0	10	10	10	10
	10	10	10	10	10	10

are covered, no protruding edges and strong construction. It performs surprisingly well for a dock this size. It doesn't go extremely low of course and one wouldn't expect it to. For instance, the 30 Hz sample does not produce a noticeable tone till a certain gain is forced, then it distorts. This isn't necessarily a bad thing, since the emphasis is on the highs, the sound signature is decidedly bright. The speaker set is deceptively loud. You can rest assured that it will liven up any outdoor/indoor party that you'd fancy taking it to. Despite its slightly high price tag, its performance and features propel it to win our best buy award.

Philips DS7550

Silver, smooth curves and not much else; the DS7550 is a very average iPod dock. It doesn't perform exceptionally in any sphere. Perhaps the one redeeming factor is its portability. And the app rounds it off to a reasonably fair product. For ₹9,000 the DS7550 is a more balanced device than the much cooler Yamaha PDX-11. But we'd urge you to look at the other two products in this category.

And the rest...

This is the main event, the place where the most heated action is. When we removed the six docks that were portable and bedside pipsqueaks what was left were sound machines, each unique in its own right, that will certainly evoke curiosity when spotted in any living room. Let's take a closer look.

Bowers & Wilkins Zeppelin Mini

We start with a bang by introducing to you the Zeppelin Mini. The first thing you notice about the mini is that they weren't kidding when they christened it the mini. The device is indeed really small but with surprisingly good amount of stereo separation for such a compact system. Behind that fabric grille are two full range three inch drivers that belt out crystal clear audio. The sound signature is fairly neutral and at low volumes it's one of the more detailed systems of the lot. The upper half is like a cross-section of a Zeppelin and has a mirrored finish. It does attract fingerprints but there's little reason to go touchy-feely in that area apart from the initial "ohh that's shiny" phase. The mini boasts a docking stand that lets you put your hand all the way around it allowing you to hold your iPod comfortably. A nice feature to have but overhyped because there's hardly a time when you end up doing that. The docking stand also allows you to flip the iPod from portrait to landscape – useful for browsing in cover flow mode or watching a YouTube video while the device is still docked. Compared to the others in the price range the Zeppelin mini's sound is on the softer side. The decibel levels you'll get from it



Logitech S715i

are modest. Also it can't take too much of sound density. Lots of frequencies get suppressed (like a kind of doppler effect) when for instance Dream Theater kicks in with double bass on a particular track. Also, its price tag is really high. At ₹30,000, go for the Zeppelin mini only if you fall in love with its looks and are swept by an overpowering desire to own speakers that come from a pedigree.

Onkyo SBX 200 & ABX-100

The SBX 200 is not much to look at, in fact it borders on the ugly. The two large drivers behind the grille are housed in a prism shaped body, with buttons on one side. The sound system ended up being one of the louder systems featured in this test. It has a sound processing feature called Sbass which when switched off essentially suppresses or enhances low frequencies. It can be toggled between three positions but we kept it at the central level while testing as it seemed to distort the bass when turned fully up. The